

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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DJIA 42392.27 ▼ 151.95 0.36% NASDAQ 19280.79 ▼ 0.2% STOXX 600 510.67 ▲ 0.6% 10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 1/32, yield 4.574% OIL \$73.13 ▲ \$1.41 GOLD \$2,658.90 ▲ \$29.70 EURO \$1.0267 YEN 157.51

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Tesla's annual vehicle** deliveries fell in 2024 for the first time in more than a decade after a surge of promotional deals in the fourth quarter failed to stimulate sales enough to top the prior-year results. **A1**
- ◆ **BYD sold a record** number of electric and hybrid vehicles in December, leading a host of Chinese peers benefiting from a government trade-in program. **B4**
- ◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** ended lower, with the S&P 500 and Nasdaq both slipping 0.2% and the Dow industrials shedding 0.4%. **B1**
- ◆ **Meta replaced its** chief policy executive, Nick Clegg, with his Republican deputy, Joel Kaplan, the latest move by the tech industry to align itself with the incoming Trump administration. **B1**
- ◆ **Apple agreed to pay** \$95 million in cash to resolve a class-action lawsuit that alleged the company obtained private communications and shared them with third parties without consent through Siri. **B3**
- ◆ **WeChat and TikTok** were cleared to continue operating their apps in Malaysia, becoming the first companies to meet license requirements meant to enhance on-line safety there. **B2**
- ◆ **Swisscom cut its** core earnings guidance as the completion of its acquisition of Vodafone Italia will be recognized in 2024, months earlier than first expected. **B3**
- ◆ **U.S. dockworkers** and their employers agreed to resume formal talks on Jan. 7, a week ahead of a potential strike that could shut down ports from Maine to Texas. **B3**

World-Wide

- ◆ **Investigators believe** the U.S. Army veteran who drove a pickup truck into a New Orleans crowd acted alone, and they have found no link between that terrorist attack and the deadly explosion of a Tesla Cybertruck in Las Vegas that was driven by another servicemember. **A1, A4**
- ◆ **The attack in New Orleans** highlights the threat of a resurgent Islamic State that has a history of inspiring disaffected individuals to commit mass murder and could force a review of U.S. national-security priorities. **A5-6**
- ◆ **South Korean police** authorized to look for evidence of professional negligence resulting in death raided the offices of the airline and airport operator involved in the Dec. 29 plane crash that killed 179 people. **A14**
- ◆ **China began the year** with a verbal broadside against U.S. defense contractors, responding to recent sales of U.S. arms to Taiwan, and reminded Trump that Beijing has tools to protect its interests. **A14**
- ◆ **The FBI sought leads** to help it identify the person who placed pipe bombs near political-party offices the night before the Jan. 6 Capitol attack, sharing previously unreleased video and new details about the suspect. **A3**
- ◆ **The Palestinian Authority** banned Al Jazeera in the occupied West Bank in the latest confrontation between the broadcaster and governments that have accused it of sympathetic coverage of Hamas. **A6**
- ◆ **Died: Ágnes Keleti**, 103, Holocaust survivor and oldest living Olympic medalist. **A6**

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New Orleans musicians performed as the city reopened Bourbon Street on Thursday, a day after a pickup truck was driven into a crowd, killing at least 14 people. The terrorist attack highlights the threat of a resurgent Islamic State. **A4-6.**

FBI Now Sees New Orleans Attack as Solo Act

By SADIE GURMAN AND NANCY A. YOUSSEF

Investigators believe the U.S. Army veteran who drove a pickup truck into a New Orleans crowd acted alone, and they have found no link between that terrorist attack and the deadly explosion of a Tesla Cybertruck in Las Vegas that was driven by another servicemember. “We’re confident, at this point, that there are no accomplices,” Christopher Raia, deputy assistant director of the Federal Bureau of Investigation’s counterterrorism division, said at a New Orleans news briefing hours before tens of thousands of people attended the Sugar Bowl at the Superdome. The college football game had been postponed a day while police bolstered security following the rampage that killed at least 14 people. Raia said authorities believed there

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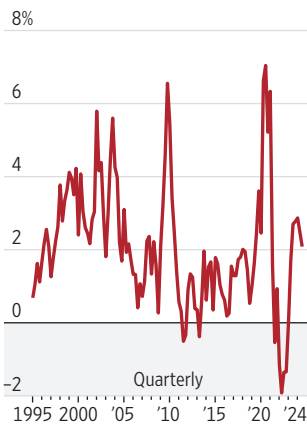
Workers, Companies In U.S. Get More Productive

By JUSTIN LAHART AND LAUREN WEBER

The U.S. is getting better at getting things done. Take Vic Viktorov, a gym owner who increased revenue at his Boston business in 2024 by 30% without adding a single salesperson to the two on staff. Instead, he has been using an artificial-intelligence model loaded with company documents, sales materials and other information. Now, he can complete in just minutes work that used to take hours, such as writing marketing plans, email drafts and social-media posts. “It allows us to be lean, nimble and fast,” Viktorov said. Productivity in the U.S., as measured by how much the average worker gets done in an hour, has been on the rise. That matters because the faster productivity grows, the faster the economy can grow as well. The success of the U.S. economy, and why it has grown so much compared with other countries over the past century and more, has hinged on its productivity. Productivity—the total output of the economy divided by hours worked—rose 2% in the third quarter compared with a year earlier, according to the Labor Department. That marked the fifth quarter in a row with an increase of 2% or better. In the five years before the pandemic, there were only two such quarters. The gains in part reflect massive changes in the U.S. economy since the onset of

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Labor productivity, change from a year earlier



Note: Seasonally adjusted Source: Labor Department via St. Louis Fed

Tesla Vehicle Deliveries Fell in 2024

By BECKY PETERSON

Tesla’s annual vehicle deliveries fell in 2024 for the first time in more than a decade, after a surge of promotional deals in the fourth quarter failed to stimulate sales enough to top the prior-year results. The world’s most valuable automaker posted a slight 2% increase in deliveries for the fourth quarter, leaning heavily on promotions, such as interest-free financing deals and

free Supercharging, to entice buyers. While it sold a record number of cars during the three-month period, the final quarterly tally still missed analysts’ expectations and fell short of the roughly 515,000 vehicles it needed to sell in the fourth quarter for Tesla to top its 2023 performance on a full-year basis. For all of 2024, Tesla delivered 1.79 million vehicles worldwide, down about 1% from a year earlier.

Tesla’s stock closed down 6% Thursday, following the release of its latest delivery figures. The company’s shares have rallied in the weeks after the U.S. election, ending 2024 up more than 61%. Chinese rival BYD has been gaining on Tesla in recent years and continued to close the gap in 2024, reporting this week that its electric-car sales grew 12% last year to about 1.76 million globally. Wall Street has largely looked past Tesla’s sales tur-

bulence and focused on Chief Executive Elon Musk’s long-term strategy to shift the company toward robotics and artificial intelligence. Tesla’s share price has nearly doubled in the weeks since the election, sending Tesla’s value to a high of \$1.5 trillion in mid-December. On New Year’s Day, Tesla was thrust into the spotlight

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◆ **China’s BYD posts record December sales.....** B4

INSIDE



BUSINESS & FINANCE TikTok’s video creators shrug off looming U.S. ban for the Chinese-owned app. **B1**



MANSSION The top 10 priciest home sales in 2024, a banner year for the ultraluxury market. **M1**

A Doctor’s Plea Sets Off Heroic Race to Save Orphans

An extraordinary mobilization of supporters came together to evacuate hundreds of children from a war zone—twice

By GABRIELE STEINHAUSER AND MOHAMED ZAKARIA

On the fourth night of the war, Dr. Abeer Abdullah sent off a desperate plea for help. Abdullah had spent the past days and nights racing to care for 370 children at the al-Mygoma Home for Orphaned Children, Sudan’s biggest orphanage, where she is medical director. The home was caught in the middle of some of the heaviest fighting in the capital Khartoum after a simmering rivalry between Sudan’s two most powerful generals boiled over into all-out violence. The war had left Mygoma with no nurses and fewer than a dozen adults to care for the children, most of whom were under the age of 1. Abdullah, a reserved, Saudi Arabia-trained general practitioner, was the only doctor. Power cuts had shut down the orphan-

age’s air conditioning in the up to 115-degree heat. Explosions shook the walls. Overwhelmed caregivers struggled to feed and hydrate newborn babies and others suffering from complex disabilities. More than once, they rushed from one room to another just to find another child lifeless in his crib. That fourth night, Abdullah sneaked out of Mygoma’s metal gate, clutching her phone and praying that the darkness would protect her from snipers positioned on nearby buildings. Next to a tree in the orphanage’s front yard, her screen lit up with a sliver of signal. Abdullah tapped out a Facebook post: “Save al-Mygoma.” Over the following weeks and months, Abdullah’s message prompted the extraordinary mobilization of a group of mostly Sudanese ci-

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1,800 Miles to Satisfy a Craving: Food Delivery Goes the Distance

Business booms for those who haul meals from kitchens in Guatemala to U.S. homes

By JOEL MILLMAN

ARLINGTON, Va.—When Marciana Cabrera misses a home-cooked meal from her native Guatemala, she places an order for food delivery—from Guatemala. “Four, probably five times a year,” says the 20-year resident of this Washington, D.C., suburb. “And, of course, at Christmas.” Her cravings this holiday season were for smoked mojarra, a fish from Guatemala’s Pacific Coast, piloy de frijole (red kidney beans) and xeca,

jam-filled pastries popular in Quetzaltenango. The 8.5-pound order arrived at her apartment on a recent Thursday—a day after she placed it—at a price of \$113. Cabrera’s was one of 44 orders delivered that day by Maik Chavez, 36, owner-operator of Maik Express of Sololá, Guatemala. He’s part of a cottage industry of Guatemalans thriving as specialty couriers of goods (mostly food) ordered by the more than three million Guatemalans residing in the U.S.

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American Firms Alter Their Stance on China

By STU WOO

SINGAPORE—During Donald Trump’s first term, U.S. companies argued that a trade war with China was bad for Americans. Businesses including Apple, Nike and small retailers said raising tariffs on imports from China would raise prices for consumers. Farmers and other businesses that exported to China warned about retaliatory tariffs from Beijing. Now, as Trump prepares for his second administration, U.S. companies have largely gone silent about the importance of the U.S.-China relationship. That is because U.S. businesses no longer see China as the land

of opportunity. The promise of China’s market has faded as its once-booming economy hits trouble. And Beijing and Washington implemented policies that make it harder for U.S. businesses to succeed in the land of 1.4 billion people. “U.S. companies are more wary about doing business in China,” said Anja Manuel, the executive director of the Aspen Security Forum and a consultant for U.S. companies doing business abroad. “You see that across all industries.” In 2023, China trailed only

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◆ **Beijing blacklists more U.S. companies.....** A14